

Chapter One

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog while the morning sun rises slowly above the distant hills and the river winds its way through the quiet valley below.

In a hole in the ground there lived a hobbit. Not a nasty, dirty, wet hole, filled with the ends of worms and an oozy smell, nor yet a dry, bare, sandy hole with nothing in it to sit down on or to eat: it was a hobbit-hole, and that means comfort.

She walked to the door. It was already late. The candle flickered once and then steadied against the draught that crept beneath the frame.